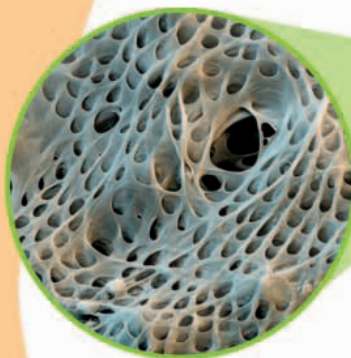


WOW!

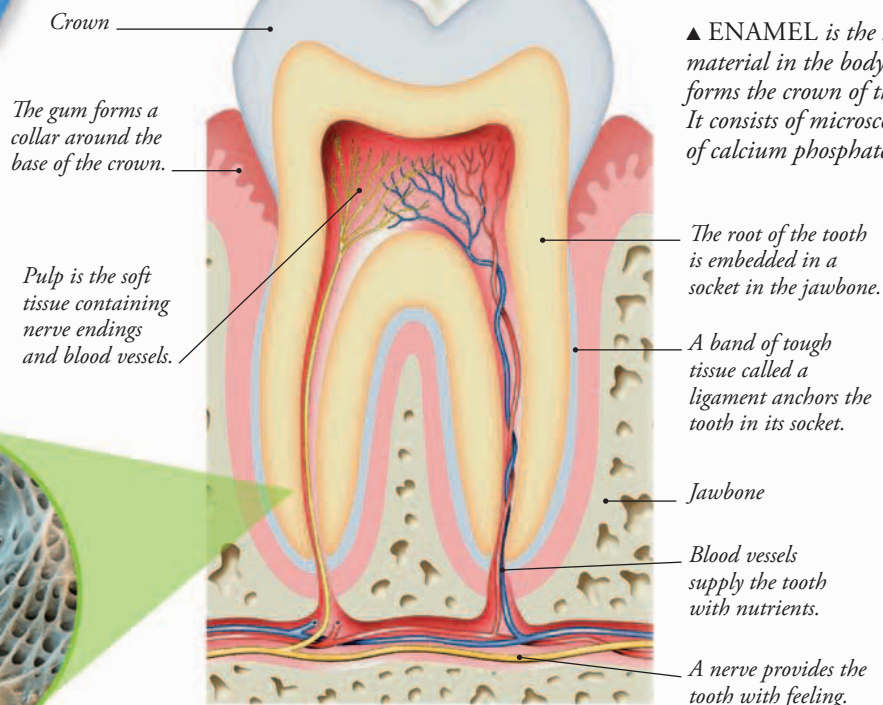
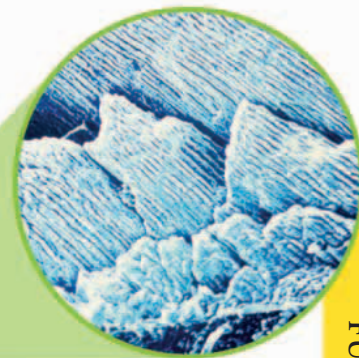
Your six salivary glands release nearly two pints (one liter) of watery, slimy saliva into your mouth every day.

▼ DENTINE is harder than bone and forms the framework of the tooth. Its honeycomb structure helps it resist the enormous squashing forces that are created during biting.



INSIDE A TOOTH

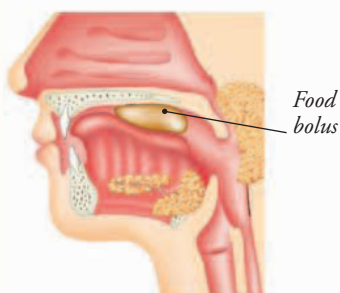
A tooth has two layers: a smooth enamel crown that provides a hard biting surface, and the dentine beneath, which also forms the root. Inside the dentine is the pulp cavity containing blood vessels that supply tooth cells, and nerve endings that detect pressure, heat, and cold, and also signal pain.



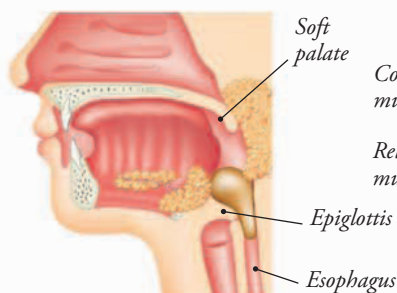
FROM MOUTH TO STOMACH

Swallowing, the process that moves food from the mouth to the stomach, has three phases. The first, in the mouth, is under your control, so you decide when

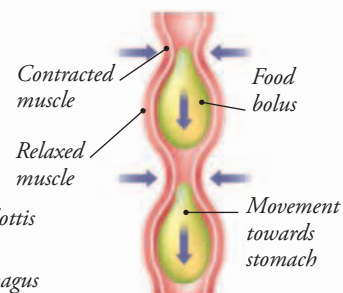
to push food into your throat. The other two stages, in the throat and esophagus, are reflex actions that happen automatically.



▲ MOUTH As chewing reaches completion, the muscular tongue molds food particles into a bolus (ball) that is pushed into the throat.



▲ THROAT Muscle contractions push the bolus towards the esophagus, while the soft palate and epiglottis stop it from entering the trachea.



▲ ESOPHAGUS Rippling waves of muscle contractions in the esophagus wall push the bolus to the stomach. This takes about ten seconds.